



OFFICE PRODUCTIVITY HACKS

The Ultimate Office Productivity Cheat Sheet Bundle

50+ Excel Formulas, Google Sheets Functions
& Keyboard Shortcuts

Excel Formulas

Google Sheets

Keyboard Shortcuts

Pro Tips

Includes: Excel • Google Sheets • Windows & Mac shortcuts

FREE RESOURCE — Save, Print & Share!

Get more free templates, tutorials, and productivity tips at:

officeproductivityhacks.com

LinkedIn: 115K+ followers • Weekly tips • Free downloads

VLOOKUP

`=VLOOKUP(lookup_value, table_array, col_index, [range_lookup])`

Look up a value in the leftmost column and return data from another column. Use FALSE for exact match.

XLOOKUP

`=XLOOKUP(lookup_value, lookup_array, return_array, [if_not_found])`

Modern replacement for VLOOKUP. Searches any column, returns any column, and handles errors gracefully.

INDEX + MATCH

`=INDEX(return_range, MATCH(lookup_value, lookup_range, 0))`

Powerful alternative to VLOOKUP. Searches any column and handles inserts/deletions better.

SUMIF

`=SUMIF(range, criteria, [sum_range])`

Sum cells that meet a single condition. For multiple conditions use SUMIFS(sum_range, range1, criteria1, ...).

COUNTIF / COUNT

`=COUNTIF(range, criteria) | =COUNTIFS(r1, c1, r2, c2, ...)`

Count cells meeting one or more conditions. Great for dashboards and frequency analysis.

IF / IFS / IFERROR

`=IF(condition, value_if_true, value_if_false)`

IFS handles multiple conditions without nesting. IFERROR(formula, fallback) catches errors cleanly.

TEXT

`=TEXT(value, format_text)` e.g., `=TEXT(A1, "MMM DD, YYYY")`

Convert numbers/dates to formatted text strings. Essential for combining values in sentences.

DATE / DATEDIF /

`=DATE(year, month, day) =DATEDIF(start, end, unit) =EDATE(date, months)`

DATE builds dates from parts. DATEDIF calculates age/tenure. EDATE adds/subtracts months.

QUERY

```
=QUERY(data, "SELECT A, B WHERE C > 100 ORDER BY B DESC")
```

Run SQL-like queries on your data. Filter, sort, aggregate, and pivot without complex formulas.

ARRAYFORMULA

```
=ARRAYFORMULA(formula) e.g., =ARRAYFORMULA(A2:A*B2:B)
```

Apply a formula to an entire range at once. Avoids copying formulas down hundreds of rows.

IMPORTRANGE

```
=IMPORTRANGE("spreadsheet_url", "Sheet1!A1:D100")
```

Pull live data from another Google Sheet. Ideal for dashboards that consolidate multiple sources.

FILTER

```
=FILTER(range, condition1, [condition2, ...])
```

Return only rows meeting your conditions. Dynamic — updates automatically when source data changes.

SORT / SORTN

```
=SORT(range, sort_col, is_ascending) =SORTN(range, n, mode)
```

SORT arranges data by column(s). SORTN returns the top N results, like a live top-10 leaderboard.

UNIQUE

```
=UNIQUE(range, [by_column], [exactly_once])
```

Extract distinct values from a range. Combine with SORT for a dynamic unique-sorted list.

FLATTEN

```
=FLATTEN(range1, [range2, ...])
```

Collapse a 2D range into a single column. Useful before UNIQUE or COUNTIF on multi-column data.

SPARKLINE

```
=SPARKLINE(data, {"charttype","line";"color","teal"})
```

Render a tiny chart inside a cell. Supports line, bar, column, and winloss types.

Microsoft Excel

Ctrl + C / Ctrl + V	Copy / Paste
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y	Undo / Redo
Ctrl + Shift + L	Toggle AutoFilter
Ctrl + T	Create Table
Ctrl + Shift + +	Insert row/column
Ctrl + -	Delete row/column
Ctrl + 1	Format Cells dialog
Alt + =	AutoSum selected range
Ctrl + `	Toggle formula view
F4	Toggle absolute reference (\$)
Ctrl + Shift + End	Extend selection to last cell
Ctrl + Home	Jump to cell A1
Alt + H + O + I	AutoFit column width
Ctrl + Shift + 1	Apply Number format
Ctrl + Shift + 4	Apply Currency format
Alt + D + P	Open PivotTable wizard
F11	Create chart in new sheet
Ctrl + W	Close workbook

Google Sheets

Ctrl + C / Ctrl + V	Copy / Paste
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Y	Undo / Redo
Ctrl + Shift + L	Toggle filter
Ctrl + Alt + Shift + H	Open Explore panel
Ctrl + /	Show all keyboard shortcuts
Ctrl + K	Insert hyperlink
Ctrl + Shift + V	Paste values only
Ctrl + Alt + V	Paste special dialog
Ctrl + Shift + E	Expand/collapse all groups
Ctrl + \	Select cells where row differs
Alt + I + R	Insert row above
Alt + I + C	Insert column left
Ctrl + Shift + Home	Select to beginning
Ctrl + Space	Select entire column
Shift + Space	Select entire row
Ctrl + F	Find
Ctrl + H	Find & Replace
Ctrl + Shift + F	Format toolbar shortcut

Mac users: replace Ctrl with Cmd | Alt with Option

Conditional Formatting Tricks

Color scales for heatmaps

Select a data range > Conditional Formatting > Color Scale. Use Red-Yellow-Green to instantly visualize high/low values — great for KPI dashboards.

Icon sets for status columns

Apply 3-icon sets (arrows, traffic lights) to status fields. Set thresholds manually for precise control rather than relying on auto-percentile defaults.

Highlight duplicates instantly

Use a custom formula: `=COUNTIF($A$1:$A$100,A1)>1` to flag duplicates across any column. Combine with a bold red fill for maximum visibility.

Apply rules to entire rows

Lock only the criteria column (\$A2) so the formula evaluates A but highlights the entire row — e.g., `=C2="Overdue"` highlights the full row red.

Pivot Table Best Practices

Use Tables as your source

Convert source data to a Table (Ctrl+T) first. Pivot Tables built on Tables auto-expand when new rows are added — no manual range updates needed.

Calculated fields for KPIs

Insert > Calculated Field lets you build metrics like Profit Margin directly inside the pivot — no helper columns in your source data required.

Group dates automatically

Right-click any date field in the pivot rows area and choose Group. Select Year, Quarter, and Month together for drill-down reporting.

Slicer + Timeline combos

Add Slicers for categorical filters and a Timeline for date ranges. Connect both to multiple pivot tables for a self-service dashboard.

Data Validation Techniques

Dropdown lists from a named range

Create a Named Range for your list values (Formulas > Name Manager), then use it as the Data Validation source. Lists update automatically when the range changes.

Whole number & date constraints

Prevent bad input: use Whole Number between 1 and 100 for scores, or Date between `TODAY()` and `TODAY()+30` to enforce booking lead times.

Dependent dropdowns

Use `INDIRECT()` in validation: `=INDIRECT(A2)` where A2 holds a category name that matches a Named Range — e.g., selecting 'Fruit' shows only fruit options in B2.

Custom formula validation

Block lowercase entries with `=EXACT(A1,UPPER(A1))`, or ensure uniqueness with `=COUNTIF($A$1:$A$100,A1)=1`. Add an error alert with a helpful message.

YOU'VE JUST LEVELED UP!

Want More Tips Like These?

Join 115,000+ professionals on LinkedIn who follow Office Productivity Hacks for weekly tips, tutorials, and free resources.

Visit Us & Get More Free Resources
officeproductivityhacks.com

- **Free Excel Templates** — Download ready-to-use workbooks
- **Google Sheets Tutorials** — Step-by-step video guides
- **LinkedIn Community** — 115K+ followers — join the conversation
- **Weekly Newsletter** — Tips delivered to your inbox



"Work smarter, not harder — one shortcut at a time."